

PANELIST PREP & RUN OF SHOW

Building for Scale: Innovative Growth & Funding Strategies

Roundtable conversation, not presentations. Audience = HUBZone small businesses ready to scale. Arc: build the capture engine → get judged ready by primes & agencies → fund the jump → scale sustainably. Goal: attendees leave with actionable ideas.

PREP-CALL NOTE: This is the working draft of our July 21 session. On our prep call we'll lock speaking order, confirm each panelist's pillar, and pick the one signature story each of you tells. Bring reactions — what to add, cut, or reframe. No slides; this is a conversation. Your panelist questions are on page 2.

RUN OF SHOW — 90 MINUTES

10:15 AM	Panelists meet at room Arrive ~15 min early. Mic/seat check with A/V, confirm speaking order, meet Eric.
10:30–10:36	Welcome & Frame Eric opens, frames "Building for Scale," sets the goal: leave with ideas you can act on. ERIC
10:36–10:51	Intros — ~5 min each Donna → Calvin → Joel. Quick, conversational — who you are + the scaling lens you bring. DONNA · CALVIN · JOEL
10:51–11:40	Moderated Round-Robin Eric drives 4–5 themes; each panelist weighs in from their pillar. Cross-talk & real stories — the heart of the session. ALL
11:40–11:50	Rapid-Fire / Cross-Talk Fast back-and-forth to surface the questions attendees are thinking before we open the floor. ALL
11:50–11:58	Live Q&A Audience questions. Eric routes to the right panelist; backup questions ready if quiet. ALL
11:58–12:00	Close & Next Steps Eric — one actionable takeaway per panelist, thank the panel & the HUBZone Council. ERIC

CROSS-PANEL & Q&A BACKUP

- Roundtable:** A HUBZone firm has 90 days and limited cash — in what order do they tackle process, partnerships, and funding before going after bigger work? (let all 3 argue their pillar)
- Roundtable:** The most expensive scaling mistake each of you sees in your lane — do they overlap?
- Q&A if quiet:** "How did you fund your first big jump?" · "Bootstrap or raise?" · "When am I ready for a prime to take me seriously?" · "Realistic timeline to the next level?"

— PANELIST QUESTIONS

Each panelist owns a pillar. Eric will tee you up by name during the round-robin — answer conversationally and tell stories. The first (orange) question is your opener; the rest are directions Eric may steer.

Donna Freitas

 **GROWTH STRATEGY & CAPTURE**

Founder & Principal, DMB & Associates · 40+ years across Fortune 500, Alaska Native Corporations, 8(a), HUBZone & small business · Author, Capture and Proposal Process (CAPP) Guide

- 1. Open us up — forty years watching companies try to grow, from Fortune 500 to HUBZone shops. Tell the room about a firm that was winning work but had no process underneath it. What happened to them?**
- You say “developing processes that become practices.” What’s the first process a HUBZone firm has to install before it’s allowed to chase bigger work?
- Most small businesses think capture means writing the proposal. Where does the real work start — and how far ahead of the RFP?
- You’ve built BD teams from scratch and mentored the owners running them. What does a scale-ready BD function look like at a 20-person firm versus a 200-person firm?
- Closer: the one discipline a HUBZone firm needs before it’s ready to scale.

Calvin J. Mitchell Jr.

 **BUYER & PRIME SIDE**

Sr. Director, Strategic Acquisition & Engagement, GDIT · Former SES Procurement Executive · NCMA Board Advisor

- 1. Give the room the inside view — you’ve been a federal SES procurement exec and now sit on the prime side at GDIT. How do big buyers actually decide who’s ready for bigger work?**
- Where’s the gap between how a small business thinks it’s evaluated and how primes/agencies really judge scale-readiness?
- What makes a prime want to team with — or invest in — a smaller firm?
- One operational thing a HUBZone firm must have in place before chasing larger, more complex contracts?
- Closer: the fastest credibility signal a growing firm can build this year.

Joel Adelman

 **FUNDING & INVESTMENT CAPITAL**

CEO, Encore Funding · Managing Partner, AdCap Growth Partners · CEO, Transcap

- 1. Lead with the Encore story — you’ve built businesses whose whole job is to be “fuel for growth.” What did you see that made you go all-in on funding growing companies?**
- A HUBZone firm just won bigger than they’ve ever won. What happens to their cash before the government pays — and what are their real options?
- Why can’t most growing contractors just lean on their bank to scale?
- You also sit on the investment side at AdCap. Receivables finance vs. asset-backed vs. investment capital — how should an owner think about which lever, and when? What makes you back a company?
- Closer: when should a business owner talk to a funding partner — at the win, or well before?